

How to learn anything 10x faster with Notebook LM in 7 days (Bonus Prompts included)

 来源: <https://x.com/KanikaBK/article/2036459326064435377>

NotebookLM is not “another ChatGPT.”

It is an AI tutor grounded in your PDFs, notes, and videos.

I stopped reading textbooks cover to cover.

NotebookLM now teaches me directly from my PDFs, slides, and notes quizzes, audio overviews, mind maps, the works.

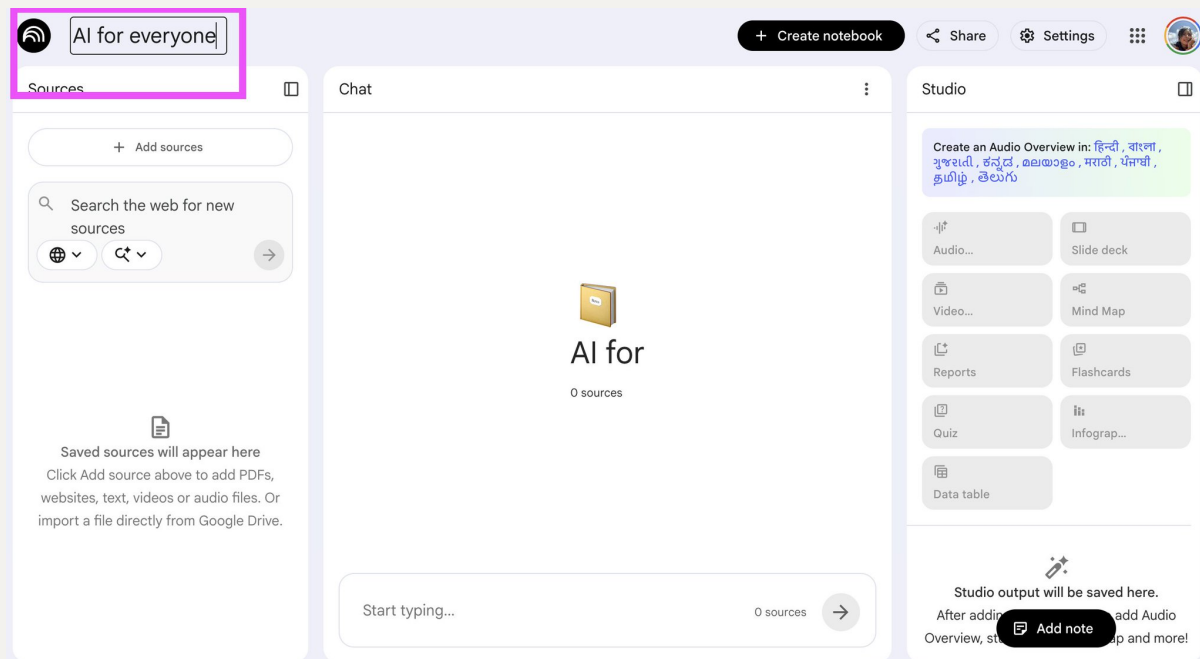
For me, it worked miraculously and I feel way more productive now.

You can steal my simple guide.

This guide shows you a 6-step workflow and a reusable prompt pack to turn any topic into a personalized study system in under a week.

So without any further delay let's get started

Step 1: Set up one notebook per topic



Name your Notebook

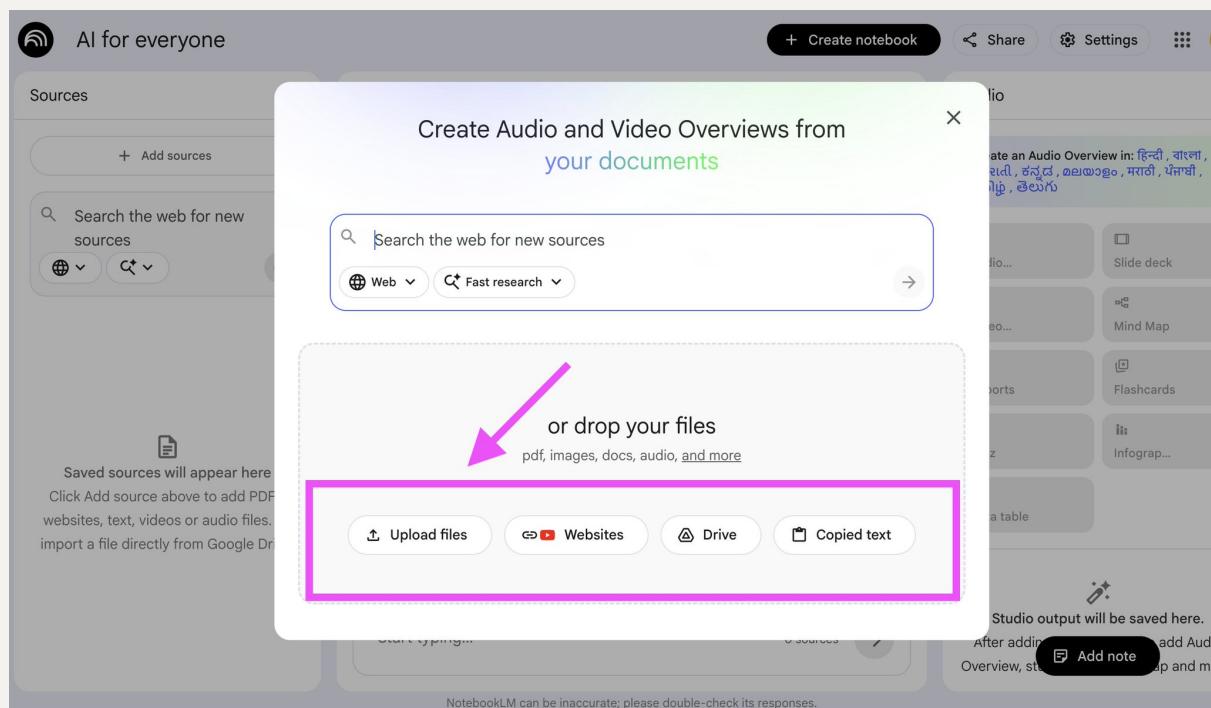
1. Go to notebooklm.google.com and create a **new notebook**.
2. Give it a **tight, exam-style name**, like “Deep Learning for Beginners” or “Corporate Finance Unit 1.”
3. Decide the scope: one notebook per **course / book / topic cluster**. People who mix everything into one notebook get generic answers and lose the speed advantage NotebookLM gives you.

Prompt (to drop in the notebook chat):

“You are my study coach for this notebook. Your job is to help me understand, memorize, and apply only the information inside these sources. Never invent facts beyond them. If something is missing, tell me what to add instead of guessing.”

Step 2: Feed it the right sources (not everything)

NotebookLM works best when it is grounded in **5–15 high-quality sources**, not 200 random PDFs.



Add your resources

Add:

- Core textbook chapters (PDFs)
- Lecture slides
- Your own notes / Google Docs
- A few high-signal web pages or papers
- One or two YouTube lectures (NotebookLM can ingest them)

As soon as you upload, NotebookLM builds a **Notebook Guide**: auto-summary, key topics, suggested questions, and quick buttons for study guides and timelines.

Prompt

Scan all current sources and give me:

- a 10-bullet high-level overview of the topic
- a list of 8–12 key concepts I must master
- any obvious gaps in the material I should fill with more sources.

The screenshot shows the NotebookLM interface. On the left, the 'Sources' panel lists several sources, including 'AI, Machine Learning, Deep L...', 'Book 1 .pdf', and several YouTube videos about AI. The main 'Chat' panel shows a conversation. A user asks, 'How do narrow and strong AI differ in capabilities?'. The AI responds with a detailed explanation of narrow and strong AI, their capabilities, and their relationship. A pink arrow points to the AI's response. Below the response, there is a button labeled '5 sources' with a right arrow, indicating that the AI has scanned the sources and provided a summary.

Scan all current sources

Step 3: Use “Explain → Compare → Apply”

I noticed that most people just ask “summarize this chapter.” That is fast but not real learning. A much more powerful pattern used by top NotebookLM teachers is **Explain → Compare → Apply**.

3.1 Explain (build foundations)

Prompt:

Teach me the content of these sources step by step, starting from zero.

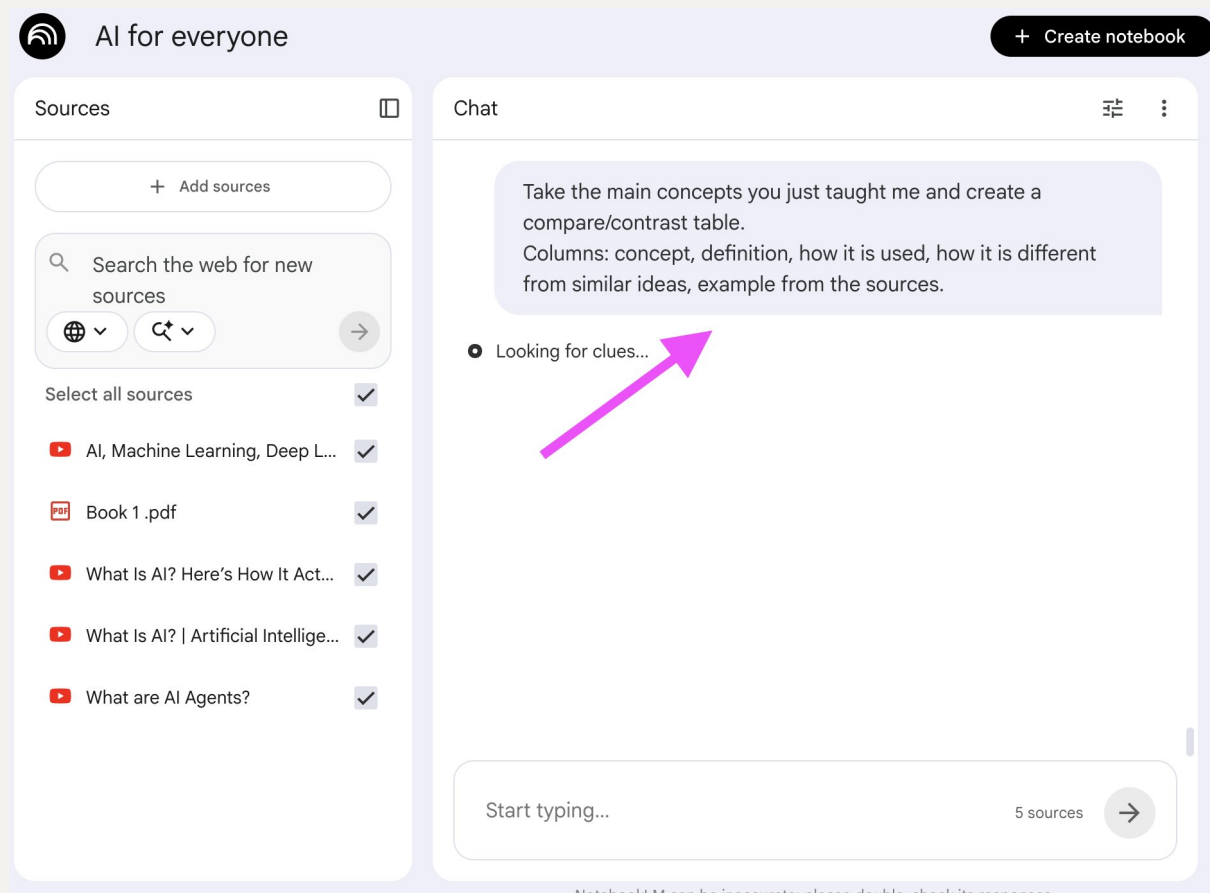
Break it into short lessons:

- Plain-language explanation
- One simple example
- A 2-line summary I could tell a friend.

Use the vocabulary from the sources and add citations for every claim.

Use the answers as mini-lessons; pin/save the best ones as notes.

3.2 Compare (build understanding)



Compare - Build Understanding

Prompt

Take the main concepts you just taught me and create a compare/contrast table.

Columns: concept, definition, how it is used, how it is different from similar ideas, example from the sources.

This forces NotebookLM to align ideas and makes the structure of the topic obvious.

3.3 Apply (build real skill)

Prompt:

Give me 5 practice questions that apply these ideas to new situations (word problems, case studies, or real-world examples).

Ask me one question at a time.

After I answer:

- **grade my answer**
- **correct it**
- **show the exact paragraph(s) in the sources you used.**

Now you are doing active recall and feedback in the same place.

Step 4: Turn your notebook into a complete study system

NotebookLM's Studio / Notebook Guide can auto-build structured learning tools for you. Most users never go past chat. Don't be that user. That is like leaving 80% of the "10x" on the table. Do you understand?

I will teach you how

4.1 Auto study guide

At the top of the Notebook Guide, click **Study Guide** (or use this prompt):

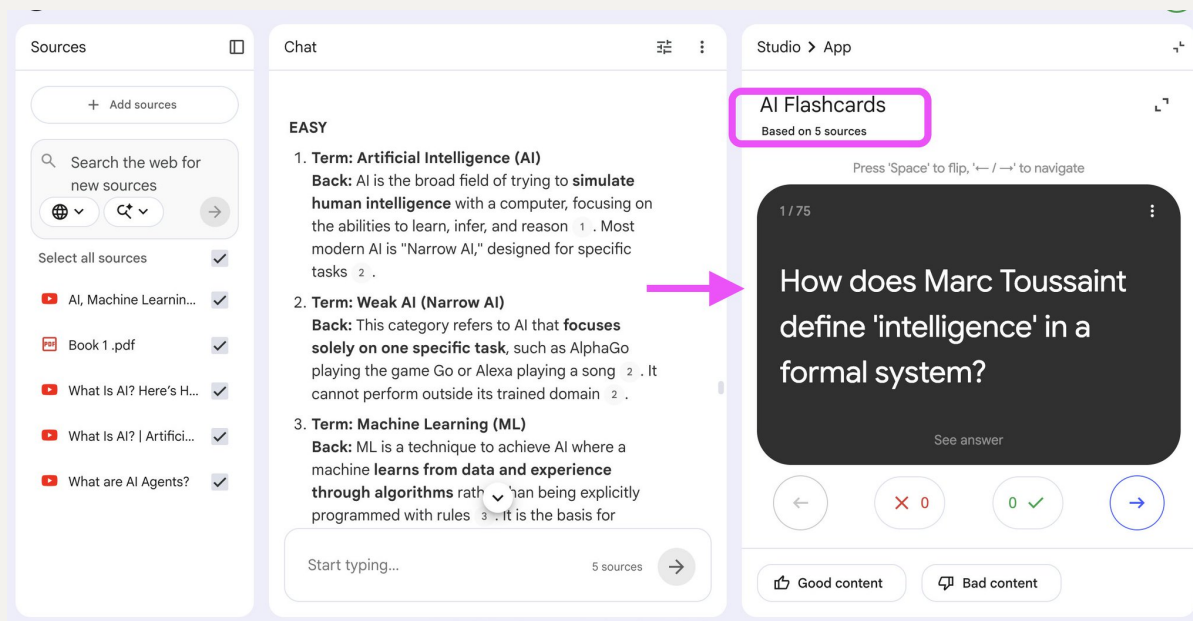
Create a structured study guide for everything in this notebook:

- **Modules and subtopics**
- **Bullet explanations**
- **Key formulas / definitions**
- **'Common mistakes' for each section.**

Ground everything in my sources with citations.

4.2 Flashcards and quizzes (real memory work)

NotebookLM can instantly generate flashcards and quizzes from your sources, including difficulty levels



NotebookLM Flash Card

Flashcard prompt:

Generate 30 flashcards from these sources:

- **front:** question or term
- **back:** concise answer + citation.

Mix basic definitions with conceptual ‘why/how’ questions.

Mark 10 as EASY, 10 as MEDIUM, 10 as HARD.

Quiz prompt:

Create a 15-question mixed quiz (MCQ + short answer) only from my sources.

Ask questions one by one.

After each, wait for my answer, then:

- tell me if I’m right
- explain the correct answer
- link to the source paragraph.

4.3 Audio / video overviews (learn while doing life like I do)

NotebookLM can turn your notebook into an **audio overview** or even a video-style explanation, so you can “listen to your textbook” while commuting or walking.

Prompt

“Create a 20-minute Audio Overview that teaches this entire notebook as if you are a patient tutor.

Order:

1. **big picture,**
2. **key ideas,**
3. **worked examples,**
4. **recap and practical tips.**

Use casual language but correct terminology.

Play this like a podcast; then come back and quiz yourself.

Step 5: Build a 7-day learning sprint with NotebookLM

Now this is optional I use it when I have to learn anything fast.

Here is a concrete mini-plan that makes “10x faster” real for me

Day 1: Setup + big picture

- Create notebook and add 5–10 core sources.
- Run the **overview prompt** and **gap prompt** from Step 2.
- Generate a high-level study guide.

Day 2–3: Explain + Compare

- Do two “Explain” lessons and one “Compare table” session per day.
- Pin/save the best explanations as written notes in NotebookLM.

Day 4–5: Apply + Quizzes

- 20–30 minutes per day of “Apply” questions and adaptive quiz sessions.

- After each wrong answer, ask: “Explain this concept again like I am 12, using a different example.”

Day 6: Audio + mind map

- Generate an Audio Overview and listen once.
- Ask: **“Turn this topic into a mind map with main branches and sub-branches, grounded in my sources.”**

Day 7: Teach-back test

- Final prompt: **Pretend I just studied this notebook and you are my examiner. Ask me 10 increasingly difficult questions that cover everything. After I answer, grade me harshly and tell me exactly what to review, with links to the source passages.**

You have now done **reduced reading, high-leverage explanation, active recall, spaced review**, and **teach-back** in one tool.

Do you understand? That is what “10x faster” actually means:

you basically skip low-yield reading time and spend nearly all your time in high-yield cognitive modes.

I hope you like the article.

I'm Kanika (@[KanikaBK](#)), specializing in AI tools, emerging trends, and niche applications. Follow for in-depth analyses, strategic insights, and professional updates to elevate your AI knowledge.